How to Use the IACR Journal Document Class

iacrj LaTeX Class Documentation (v0.9.1)

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Abstract

This is documentation for the iacrj.cls document class that can be used for the three IACR journals ToSC, TCHES, and CiC. The iacrj document class is intended to supercede both iacrcc.cls and iacrtrans.cls.

Keywords: Template, LaTeX, IACR

Introduction

This document is a guide to using the `iacrj` document class for three IACR journals:

- IACR Transactions on Symmetric Cryptology (ToSC),
- IACR Transactions on Cryptographic Hardware and Embedded Systems (TCHES),
- IACR Communications in Cryptology (CiC)

The `iacrj.cls` class is intended to replace both `iacrtrans` and `iacrcc`.

The biggest difference between `iacrj` and `iacrtrans` is the way that metadata is supplied by authors. Rather than using the `\author` macro to enclose all author names, each author is added with a `\addauthor` macro. The macros for supplying metadata are defined in the companion `metacapture.sty` LaTeX style file. The `metacapture.sty` package is documented separately, but that documentation is mostly of interest to designers of other LaTeX document classes.

The class is still in development and feedback and comments are welcome. The latest version can be found at: `publish.iacr.org/iacrj`. There is also a github repository where you can open issues or to submit pull requests. The complete package consists of four files. `iacrj.cls` is the main document class that loads the `metacapture.sty` package. `iacrj-doc.tex` is used to produce this PDF file. `iacrj-template.tex` can be used as a starting point for writing an article for ToSC, TCHES, or CiC. The only difference between these is that there is a `journal` argument in `\documentclass`.

NOTES

- The production system to which you submit your final version requires that the main LaTeX file should be `main.tex`. You might as well start that way by copying `iacrj-template.tex` to `main.tex`.

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- The default fonts are provided by the document class. Please do not change this.
- Avoid using too many packages. Many authors are lazy and just copy what they used in the past. This is a very bad habit, and some packages either won't work or need to be loaded in a prescribed order. There is a list of forbidden packages at https://publish.iacr.org/forbidden.
- Don't try to change the `hyperref` options, the bibliography style, the page style, or the page numbering.
- Don't use macros like `\if` or `\include` inside any metadata like the title or abstract.
- Footnotes are handled differently in this class, and in particular `\thanks` is disabled.

1 Invocation and usage

The class supports the following class options with `\documentclass{iacrj}`

`[journal=tosc]` is used to select formatting for ToSC, `[journal=tches]` is used for TCHES, and `[journal=cic]` is used for CiC. One of these must be specified.

`[version=preprint]` for preprints (without copyright info, default)

`[version=submission]` for submissions (anonymous, with line numbers). If desired, this can be combined with `[notanonymous]` if the call for papers requires non-anonymous submissions.

`[version=final]` for final papers. This imposes some additional requirements like a license and a text-only abstract in the `textabstract` environment.

`[biblatex]` may be used if you prefer using BibLaTeX to BibTeX. Note that we do not support options to be passed to BibLaTeX, as they may conflict with the style of the journal. We use a bibliography style based on the alpha style (e.g., [RSA78]).

`[floatrow]` load the `floatrow` package. This is useful when you have fancy figures or tables. In either case, `iacrj` will customize how tables and figures are laid out.

The current date of compilation time is automatically added to the footer of the front page. If you want to adjust this date you can use the `\documentdate` macro (e.g. `\documentdate{2023-10-05}`) or use `\documentdate{}` to omit adding the date.

The `iacrj` class automatically loads `hyperref` after all other packages. If you need some packages like `cleveref` to be loaded *after* `hyperref`, you should read Section 5.

2 Macros to add title and author information

2.1 Title

A title is added using the `\title` macro, it has a number of optional arguments:

`running`	The running title displayed in the headers.
`plaintext`	A text version of the title. This is required if you use macros in the main argument to the `\title` macro.

An example using all the optional arguments would look like:

```
\title[running   = {How to use the iacrj class},
       plaintext = {How to use the iacrj LaTeX class}
      ]{How to use the \texttt{iacrj} \LaTeX\ class}
```

The `plaintext` option is only required if you use macros in your title (it is required in the example because the `\LaTeX` and `\texttt` macros are used). Inline mathematics and accents like `\"u` are allowed in plain text. Note that LaTeX has defaulted to UTF-8 input since 2019, so just ü is preferred to `\"u`. Note that both `\thanks` and `\footnote` are disabled because footnotes are forbidden on titles. You may instead use the `\genericfootnote` macro described in section 2.6. The `running` option is only required if the title does not fit on a single line in the header.

This is a good time to explain why plaintext versions are required. These are used by the journal production system that must produce titles for various other purposes. Examples include the registration of the DOI with `crossref.org`, the production of RSS and OAI-PMH, the indexing of your article with search engines, and the creation of HTML pages for your article.

2.2 Subtitle

An author is always allowed to have a two-line title by inserting a newline `\\` into the main argument of `\title`, but some authors may instead want a "subtitle" that is typeset in a smaller font under the title. This can be accomplished with the `\subtitle` macro. This also takes an optional `plaintext` attribute if the main argument to `\subtitle` contains any macros. A full example could be:

```
\subtitle[plaintext={A LaTeX tutorial}]{%
    A \LaTeX\ tutorial\protect\footnote{Thanks to Leslie Lamport}}
```

2.3 Authors

Author information is entered using the `\addauthor`, `\addaffiliation`, and `\addfunding` macros. Authors are asked to enter this information in a structured way so that we can provide it to indexing agencies. The `\author` macro is disabled.

Authors are listed individually using repeated calls to the `\addauthor` command. There are a number of optional arguments to `\addauthor`:

`inst`	A numerical list of indices specifying an institution in the affiliation array (see below). These are used as footnote symbols to link to affiliations.
`orcid`	Create a small clickable orcid logo next to the authors name looking like and linking to the authors ORCID (see: `https://orcid.org`).
`footnote`	Create an author-specific footnote. The `\footnote` macro is disabled inside the `\addauthor` macro.
`surname`	Indicate the surname of the author for indexing purposes.
`onclick`	Creates a symbol displayed next to the author name that is a clickable link to a URL that is supplied in the argument. This may be used for a link to a person web page. Links to web pages can also be specified in the `footnote` argument with the `\url` macro, but authors should be formatted in a consistent way.
`email`	Define the e-mail address of this author. Note that at least one e-mail address is required when `[version=final]` is used.

We **strongly** recommend that authors enter their ORCID ID into the paper, because this ensures that they will get citation credit for their papers. Authors can use the `surname` argument to indicate what part of the author name is the surname. This is used only for metadata processing, and is especially useful for cases with middle names *and/or* double surnames which might be confusing.

When the URL provided to the `onclick` option contain characters with a "special" meaning in LaTeX they might render incorrectly. An example with some of the common characters ~, %, and # is

```
onclick = {https://www.webpage.com/\string~\%\#/}
```

which displays ↗ next to the author name.

An example of `\addauthor` using all the optional arguments is given below. In this case the author has `inst={1,2}` to indicate that they are affiliated with the first and second affiliations that are entered later with `\addaffiliation`:

```
\addauthor[orcid    = {0000-0000-0000-0000},
           inst     = {1,2},
           footnote = {Thanks to my supervisor for the support.},
           onclick  = {https://www.mypersonalwebpage.com},
           email    = {alice@accomplished.com},
           surname  = {Accomplished},
          ]{Alice Accomplished}
```

The `\thanks` macro is disabled inside `\addauthor`, so the `footnote` option on `\addauthor` should be used instead.

The author names displayed in the header are constructed automatically, but if this extends to more than one line, you should use the `\authorrunning` macro to define a list of authors in the header. You can use "et al" to abbreviate the list, or use only surnames, or you can simply set it to an empty string to omit the author list in the header.

2.4 Affiliations

Affiliations are listed individually using the `\addaffiliation` command *after* the last author has been added using `\addauthor`. There are a number of optional arguments to `\addaffiliation`:

`ror`	Provide the Research Organization Registry (ROR) indentifier for this affiliation (see: https://ror.org). This is used for meta-data collection only.
`department`	Department or suborganization name.
`street`	Street address.
`city`	City name.
`state`	State or province name.
`postcode`	Zip or postal code.
`country`	Country name. Required if `[version=final]` is used in the document options.

There is an online tool at publish.iacr.org/funding to help you find ROR identifiers, and you are strongly urged to include these so that grant agencies and employers will be notified when an article appears with the appropriate ROR id. The `city` and `country` arguments are used to display the affiliation. An example using all the optional arguments would look like:

```
\addaffiliation[ror        = {05f950310},
                department = {Computer Security and Industrial Cryptography},
                street     = {Kasteelpark Arenberg 10, box 2452},
                city       = {Leuven},
                state      = {Vlaams-Brabant},
                postcode   = {3001},
                country    = {Belgium}
               ]{KU Leuven}
```

2.5 Funding information

Authors should use the `\addfunding` macro to make sure that funding agencies can find papers published under their sponsorship. An example is:

```
\addfunding[fundref = {100000001},
            grantid = {CNS-1237235},
            country = {United States}]{National Science Foundation}
\addfunding[ror     = {00pn5a327},
            country = {United States}]{Rambus}
```

In this example, the author acknowledges a grant from the National Science Foundation and support from Rambus (with no `grantid`). The inclusion of funding from an agency without a `grantid` might be appropriate if the author simply received support for a visit.

The complete list of optional arguments for `\addfunding` is:

`fundref`	An identifier from the Crossref funder registry.
`ror`	An identifier from the Research Organization Registry (ROR). A `fundref` identifier is preferred for `\addfunding`.
`country`	The country of the funding agency.
`grantid`	The identifier of the grant that is assigned by the agency who provided it.

You can use the online tool at `publish.iacr.org/funding` to help you find `fundref` and `ror` identifiers.

Note that `\addfunding` **does not** automatically create footnotes or an acknowledgements section to identify funding - it only collects the metadata for indexing. If you wish to include such visible annotations, you can use the `footnote` option on `\addauthor`, or the `\genericfootnote`, or add a separate acknowledgements section. Some funding agencies have specific requirements for how they want to be acknowledged in the paper.

2.6 Footnotes

Authors may be accustomed to using `\thanks` for footnotes indicating affiliation, email, or funding, but the `\thanks` macro is disabled and you should use other methods described in this document.

- Footnotes on titles are not supported. You should use `\genericfootnote` to place a footnote on the first page without a reference. This is useful to indicate this is a full / extended version of a published paper, or to indicate funding relationships for the authors. This is an optional macro that may be repeated for multiple footnotes.

- For a footnote on an author, use the `footnote` option on `\addauthor`. This can be used for indicating that the author's affiliation for the work was different than their current affiliation, or to indicate contact address, or a previous name, etc.

Footnotes may be used elsewhere in the paper, but please do not overuse them.

2.7 License

When the `version=final` document mode is used, the author needs to provide a supported license. In all other modes this information is not required and is ignored if it is provided. At present the only acceptable license is `CC-BY-4.0`. An example would look like:

```
\license{CC-BY-4.0}
```

2.8 Keywords

Use `\keywords{keyword1, keyword2}` to give a list of keywords or key phrases. This is an optional macro that should appear before the abstract. Individual keywords should be separated by commas. If the argument to `\keywords` contains math or macros, then you must supply an additional set of text-only keywords; for example:

```
\keywords[rings, arithmetic on Z]{rings, arithmetic on $\mathbb{Z}$}
```

2.9 Abstract

Abstracts serve several purposes in a journal article, including both summarization and indexing. An abstract should be a self-contained mini-document that describes the contributions of the paper. It should be free of bibliographic references and also free of undefined terminology introduced in the paper. It is acceptable to use mathematical notation, but this kind of content is not useful for indexing.

For this reason, the `iacrj` document class uses two kinds of abstracts. The first (traditional) form of abstract is entered with the `abstract` environment as usual. Note that the keywords should be given before starting the `abstract` environment.

For `final` versions of papers, an additional "text-only" abstract is required. This abstract is contained in the `textabstract` environment, and should not contain user-defined macros. It will be used for indexing and production of HTML pages to describe the paper. As such, it is just as important as the classical `abstract` of a paper because it contains a textual summary that readers will use to decide if the paper is worth reading. The only difference is that the contents of the `textabstract` is constrained on what it may contain.

You may use unicode such as in `Paul Erdős` or diacriticals like `F\"ur Elise`. You may also use inline or display mathematics in the `textabstract` environment as well as (for example) the `itemize` environment. User-defined macros are *not* allowed. We do not have a complete list of allowed LaTeX(which can be succesfully converted to HTML) but but you will find out when you upload your final version at https://publish.iacr.org.

The contents of this environment will be written to a file that ends with `.abstract` when you compile your LaTeX, but will not be displayed in the final PDF except as metadata. Note that `\begin{textabstract}` must appear on a line by itself.

2.10 Theorems

The `iacrj` class uses the $\mathcal{AMS}$ packages to typeset math. In particular, it loads the `amsthm` package, and predefines the following environments:

`theorem`	`definition`	`remark`
`proposition`	`example`	`note`
`problem`	`exercise`	`case`
`lemma`	`property`	
`conjecture`	`question`	
`corollary`	`solution`	
`claim`		

Note that the `proof` environment automatically adds a QED symbol at the end of the proof. If the QED symbol is typeset at a wrong position, you can force its position with `\qedhere`.

3 Auxiliary files

One goal of the `iacrj.cls` file is to automate the production of machine-readable metadata in separate files. Users of LaTeX will already be used to seeing this with the `.log`, `.aux`, `.bbl`, `.blg`, `.toc`, and `.out` files produced by BibTeX and the `hyperref` package. You need not be concerned about these, but if your main LaTeX file is called `main.tex`, then the extra files that are produced are:

- a flat text file `main.meta` containing all metadata from the paper. When you compile `main.tex`, it will produce the metadata from `main.tex`, and when you run `bibtex` and `latex` again, it will append the citation data from BibTeXinto the `main.meta` file as well.
- a file `main.abstract` that contains the contents of the abstract for the paper provided with the `textabstract` environment. This will be used to show the abstract on the web.

4 Typesetting the Bibliography

Having good bibliographic references is very important for the visibility of the journal. Since we don't use a commercial editor, authors need to make sure themselves that references are standardized and clean. We strongly encourage authors to use bibliographic data from http://www.dblp.org or https://cryptobib.di.ens.fr/. All references should have DOIs if at all possible.

You must use either BibTeX or BibLaTeX; you may not format your own bibliography. If you use BibTeX, then the `iacrj` class will load the `\bibliographystyle{alphaurl}` style. You may not change this. If you use BibLaTeX, then this is done using `\documentclass[biblatex]{iacrj}` instead of `\usepackage{biblatex}`; the latter will generate an error because the `iacrj.cls` file loads BibLaTeX with a specific style.

Here are some example citations: the RSA paper [RSA78], the AES standard [NIS01], and [Koc96].

For the IACR Communications in Cryptology, you will be required to upload your BibTeX files rather than just the `bbl` file. Many authors use the `cryptobib` BibTeX files, and you need not upload those with your paper. They can be referenced as `\bibliography{cryptobib/abbrev1,cryptobib/crypto}`

5 Package load order

LaTeX suffers from the weakness of having a global namespace for macros. As a result, it is possible that some packages may overwrite the definitions of another package that was loaded earlier. The biggest offender for this seems to be the `hyperref` package, which overwrites some basic macros in LaTeX itself. The `iacrj` document class loads `hyperref`, but it provides a mechanism for loading packages *after* `hyperref`. If the file `after-hyperref.sty` exists in the directory of your main file, then it will be included after loading `hyperref`. As an example, to load `cleveref` after `hyperref`, you can create a file `after-hyperref.sty` that contains:

```
\RequirePackage{cleveref}
```

A complete survey of the conflicts between packages is beyond the scope of this document, but some known conflicts between packages are documented in the `pkgloader` package. It is wise to read the documentation for any package you use to make sure there are no conflicts with other packages loaded by `iacrj.cls`.

6 Some recommendations

LaTeX distribution, and worklow. LaTeX distributions are available on a variety of platforms. In particular, we recommend the TeX Live distribution, which is updated regularly, includes a large number of packages, and is available on many platforms. We use the texlive medium scheme in our cloud service to compile final versions of papers.

Pictures. We recommend the use of the `tikz` package to render pictures. In particular, a large variety of crypto pictures made with `tikz` is available at `iacr.org/authors/tikz/`

External pictures. The `graphicx` is loaded by the class, and is recommended for external figures. The submission server does not support `svg` format for included graphics, so you should convert `svg` files to a supported format. If possible, external figures should be in a vector format (PDF or EPS). Note that the `\includegraphics` command will automatically select a file with what it thinks should be the right extension, so if you write `\includegraphics{figure}` and have two files `figure.gif` and `figure.eps`, it will try to select the correct one.

Floats. Figure captions should be below the figures, and table captions above the tables. The `float` package loaded by the class should take care of this automatically. If want to have several figures side by side, see the `[floatrow]` option.

Tables. We recommend the `booktabs` package to typeset tables.

Algorithms. We recommend the `algorithmicx` packages for algorithms (in particular, `algpseudocodex` for pseudo-code).

7 Further information

If you are a LaTeX novice, you may wish to consult the following documents:

- General LaTeX documentation, such as the (not so) short introduction to LaTeX 2_ε;
- The amsmath documentation is useful for learning how to typeset mathematics.

Acknowledgments

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References

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